36-Day Amazon PM Study Guide

Day 1. Getting familiar with Amazon's PM Interview

Tasks

Read Lewis' Amazon PM interview process overview: "What should I expect in a Product Manager interview at Amazon and how should I prepare?" qr.ae/RDyUTR

Goal

Get to know the scope and nature of the Amazon PM interview.

Day 2. Traditional and Behavioral Questions

Tasks

- Read the "Winning the Behavioral Interview" chapter in *Decode and Conquer*.
- Review Amazon's Leadership Principles: www.amazon.jobs/principles
- Draft and polish your answers for the following questions:
    - Tell me about yourself.
    - Why Amazon?
- Practice and get feedback from your practice partner

Goals

Of all the tech companies, Amazon is the most devoted to its corporate values, called the Amazon Leadership Principles. This devotion manifests itself heavily in their interview process. At least half of your interview questions will be behavioral in nature, focused on their 14 Leadership Principles.

Internalize Amazon's values deeply as you will have a lot of work ahead of you when preparing your behavioral interview responses.

Day 3-7. Drafting Responses to Behavioral Questions

Task

Using the DIGS method, prepare behavioral interview responses for each Amazon Leadership Principle below. To make it easier for you, I've provided this template for you to draft your responses: bit.ly/AMZNInterviewStories

AMAZON PRINCIPLE	SUGGESTED QUESTION	SAMPLE ANSWER*
Customer Obsession	Walk us through a time when you helped a customer through a difficult process and what that looked like.	Helping a Customer
Ownership	Give me an example of when you took a risk and failed.	Risk and Failure
Invent and Simplify	Tell me a time when you created an innovative product.	Creating an Innovative Product
Are Right, A Lot	Tell me about a time when you observed two business opportunities to improve ROI, and how did you determine they were connected?	Connected ROI
Learn and Be Curious	How do you find the time to stay inspired, acquire new knowledge, and innovate in your work?	Learning Outside of Work
Hire and Develop The Best	Tell me about a time when you had to deal with a poor performer on your team.	N/A
Insist on the Highest Standards	Tell me a time when you could have stopped working on something but you persisted.	N/A
Think Big	Tell me a time when you proposed a new business.	See chapter *Strategy: New Market Entry* for inspiration
Bias for Action	Describe how you would handle a busy situation where three people are waiting for help from you.	Handling a Busy Situation
Frugality	Tell me a time when you came up with a clever way to save money for the company.	N/A
Earn Trust	Tell me a time when you earned the trust of a group.	Earning the Trust of a Group
Dive Deep	Tell me about a time when you had to dive deep into data and the results you achieved.	Diving Deep into Data
Have Backbone; Disagree and Commit	Tell me about the most difficult interaction you had at work.	Most Difficult Interaction
Deliver Results	Tell me a time when you overcame an obstacle and delivered the results.	Overcoming an Obstacle

*Refer to the table of contents for the appropriate section in this book

Source / *PM Interview Questions* and Amazon.com website

Goals

Complete drafts for each Amazon Leadership Principle.

Day 8. Get Feedback to Your Behavioral Responses

Task

Find a practice partner and get feedback on your responses. You can either present your stories in outline form or a more formal mock interview setting.

Goal

Have answers that are:

- Easy-to-understand and follow
- Thoughtful
- Indicate your role in the story, especially whether you were an owner vs. a participant
- Have an impressive, not merely good, achievement

Day 9 and 10. Get familiar lifetime value questions

Background Reading

- Read the *Lifetime Value* chapter in *Interview Math*.
- Follow the lifetime value (LTV) example in *Interview Math*: Starbucks' Lifetime Value.

Exercises

Do the following exercises:

- In *PM Interview Questions*
    - Apple iPhone LTV
    - Kindle Pricing Error
- In *Interview Math*
    - AT&T New iPhone Promotion
    - American Express I
    - American Express II
    - Crest Toothpaste
    - New York Times Website

Goal

- Internalize the LTV framework.
- Gain mastery in applying LTV, in detail, to a variety of challenging questions.

Day 11 and 12. Get familiar pricing questions

Background Reading

Get familiar with the two categories of pricing questions, new and existing products, by reading the Pricing chapter in *Rise Above the Noise*.

Exercises

Do the following exercises:

- Existing Product Pricing in *Interview Math*
    - Google Nexus Phone
    - Star Wars 7 Ticket Price
    - Starbucks Coffee Latte
- New Product Pricing in *PM Interview Questions*
    - Google Driverless Car Pricing
    - Google and Teleportation
    - Pricing UberX

Goals

- Know the difference between existing and new product pricing questions.
- Know which framework to use for each one.
- Gain proficiency in answering both types of questions

Day 13 to 36. Follow Day 2 to 25 from the Google PM prep guide.

Substitute exercises with Amazon-specific ones from *PM Interview Questions*. It is unlikely that Amazon PM interviews will include coding or technical interview questions, so you can avoid technical interview prep, if you are short on time.